



INTERNAL REFERENCE
VERSION 1.1 · JUNE 2026

THE ONBOARDING PLAYBOOK

How a stranger becomes a Dormers regular

The whole story — from the first tap on the website to a hot meal at the door, and every screen, decision, and bit of behind-the-scenes magic in between.

Written for the whole team

Plain-English story + technical appendix

3 customer journeys, mapped

What's inside

This is meant to be read like a story, not a manual. **Part 1** walks through onboarding the way a customer actually lives it — in plain English, with maps and diagrams at every turn. **Part 2** is for engineers: the exact files, tables, and schedules underneath it all.

Two things to look out for as you read:

- A **numbered milestone strip** sits at the top of every page so you always know where you are in the journey (the orange one is "you are here").
- **Decision diagrams** show the forks — the moments where the path splits depending on who the person is or what they choose.

■ Rule — how it must behave

■ By design — a deliberate choice

■ Heads-up — a gotcha to know

■ Safeguard — what protects us

PART 1 — THE STORY (FOR EVERYONE)

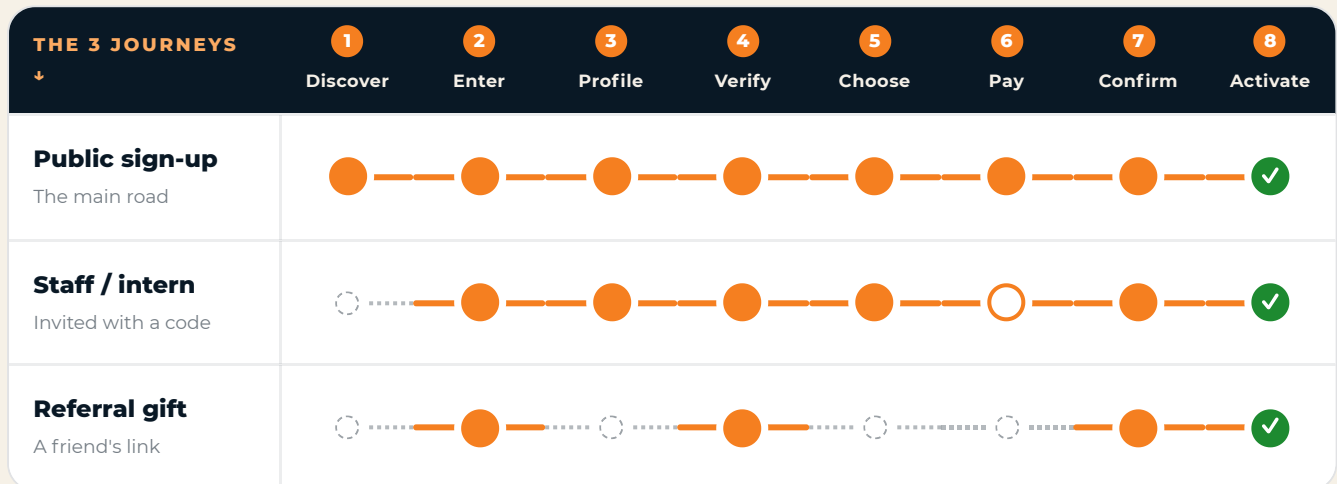
★	The journey at a glance	All three customer types on one map
1	The big picture	What onboarding is, and why it's tricky
2	Three front doors	Sign-up · staff claim · referral gift
3	The sign-up wizard, step by step	The 7–8 screens, and the religious fork
4	Proving it's really you	WhatsApp code, then email code
5	The account that gets created	What we keep, and the staff link
6	Choosing a plan & what it costs	Four plans, the veg-mix, staff pricing
7	Checkout & payment	Credits, the kitchen cut-off, the guards
8	Right after they pay	WhatsApp · email · invoice
9	Going live: first meal	The daily clockwork that activates them
10	The staff & intern path	Claim → plan → renewal → offboarding
11	The referral path & rewards	The gift and the four reward layers
12	What keeps it safe	Fraud, races, and double-charges

PART 2 — TECHNICAL APPENDIX (FOR ENGINEERS)

A– F	Routes · data · integrations · cron · engines · glossary	The exact wiring
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The journey at a glance

Here's the whole thing on one page. Everyone passes through the same eight milestones — but **how** they pass through depends on which of the three doors they came in. This map shows where the three journeys overlap, where they split apart, and where they come back together.



● On the path ○ Conditional — staff only pay for the 6-day week ○ Skipped on this journey

● First meal — journey complete

They all meet at "Verify".

No matter the door, everyone proves their phone and email. That's the one universal checkpoint.

The referral friend takes a shortcut.

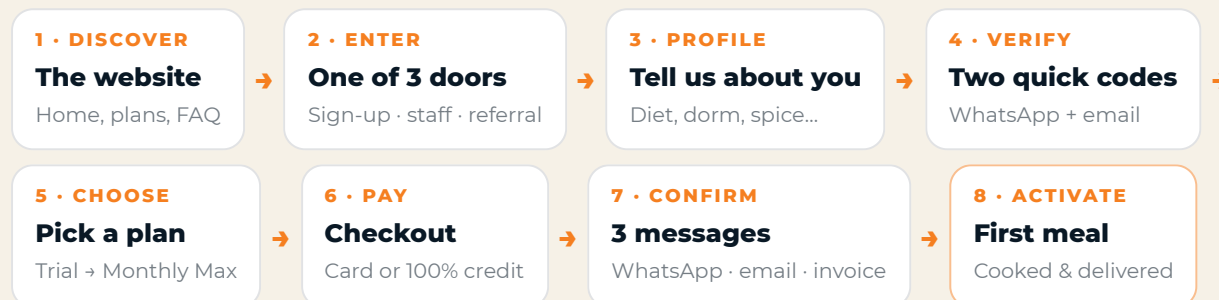
No wizard, no plan, no payment — they get a free Welcome Meal and go straight to the table. (They can convert to a paid plan later, rejoining the main road.)

Staff get a private plan.

A hidden Staff Monthly: the 5-day week is free, the 6-day week is a flat AED 80. Only the 6-day option actually pays.

The big picture

Onboarding is the most important stretch of a customer's life with us: the journey from *"who's Dormers?"* to a warm meal landing at their door — and them wanting the next one. It runs across the marketing site, a friendly sign-up, two quick identity checks, picking a plan, paying, and a quiet chain of systems that schedule the meal and tell the kitchen to cook it.



Why onboarding is worth understanding properly

It has three doors.

A normal sign-up, a staff/intern claim, and a referral gift. They share one engine but start very differently — and the referral door skips the wizard entirely.

Real money shows up early.

Actual cards, coupons, and credits. A handful of guards make sure nobody's double-charged and no price can be fiddled with.

It's half human, half clockwork.

Some steps happen the instant you tap; others wait for a scheduled "tick" — like activating a plan at midnight or counting a delivery at 8 PM, all on Dubai time.

BY DESIGN

The customer's app (the dashboard) is intentionally **light and calm**; the marketing site is intentionally **dark and bold** — an interface and a brochure are two different jobs. The sign-up wizard is locked light; the referral page is locked dark. That's a choice, not a bug to "fix".

Three front doors

Everyone ends up in the same place — a verified account with a plan — but they walk in through one of three entrances. Knowing which door someone used tells you most of what you need to know about their experience.

? Which door did this person come through?

PUBLIC

They found us. Tapped *Get Started* on the site → the full sign-up wizard → pick a plan on the dashboard.

STAFF

We invited them. A WhatsApp code → claim it → the same wizard → a staff-only plan page.

REFERRAL

A friend invited them. A `/r/` link → verify on the spot → a free Welcome Meal, no wizard.

DOOR 1 • PUBLIC

Path: `/home` → `/login` → `/onboarding`

The main road. A student finds the site, signs up, completes the wizard, and chooses a plan.

DOOR 2 • STAFF

Path: `code` → `/staff/claim` → `/onboarding` → `/staff/plan`

An intern, invited by an admin, claims a one-time code, then onboards and lands on the staff plan.

DOOR 3 • REFERRAL

Path: `/r/[code]` → `verify` → `dashboard`

A friend's link. Verify phone + email, claim the gift, and you're at the table — wizard skipped.

HEADS-UP • CURRENT STATE

On the live site today, the navbar's **Log In** and **Get Started** buttons point to a `/maintenance` holding page, not to `/login`. The whole funnel is built and working — but the *public* door is currently closed, so people are arriving via direct links, staff claims, and referrals for now. (Worth confirming with the owner — see Appendix F.)

The sign-up wizard, step by step

The wizard asks one thing at a time and feels more like a friendly chat than a form — it's the only place in the product where we lean into emoji. Most choices move you along on their own; a couple have a *Continue* button. And because we save your progress as you go, a refresh never costs you anything. There are 7 steps — or 8 for "Religious Preference" folks, who get one extra screen.

? Did they pick "Religious Preference"?

YES

An **extra screen** appears: pick which days are vegetarian (the rest are non-veg). That's the 8th step.

NO

Skip straight past it — 7 steps total, no veg-days screen.

BY DESIGN · WHY THE ORDER LOOKS ODD

We ask "5 or 6 days?" **before** the veg-days screen on purpose. The veg-days picker only lets you choose up to one less than your week length — so settling the week first avoids an annoying "oops, too many days" correction later.

1 What do you eat? 🍗 🥬 🌱

Non-Vegetarian, Veg, or "Religious Preference" (a mix of veg and non-veg days). This one pick shapes their price and what the kitchen makes for them.

Saved as: meal_preference_type · moves on automatically

2 How many days a week? 📅 17

Mon–Sat (6 days) is the standard rhythm — one day off (Sunday). **Mon–Fri (5 days)** is lighter and cheaper.

Saved as: week_type · moves on automatically

+ Which days are veg? — only if "Religious"

Pick the vegetarian days. The count caps at one less than the week (so a 6-day customer picks 1–5 veg days). This is the bonus 8th screen.

Saved as: veg_days · only shown for "Religious Preference"

3 Anything you can't eat?

Any of Nuts, Dairy, Gluten, Shellfish, Eggs, Soy — or "None". Pick as many as apply.

Saved as: allergens · Continue

...and the rest of the wizard

4

How spicy? 🌿 🌶️ 🔥 💀

Mild, Medium, Hot, or Extra Hot. A taste preference the kitchen honours.

Saved as: `spice_level_preference` · moves on automatically

5

Where do you live?

Pick from a live list of known dorms (The Myriad, KSK Homes, Yugo, DSOA Residence, Study World...) or "Other" and type it in.

Saved as: `dorm_name` · "Other" quietly flags out-of-zone

6

Which university?

From a curated list (AUD, Murdoch, Middlesex, Heriot-Watt, Manipal, and more) or "Other".

Stored with the account · Continue

7

Your name & WhatsApp → a code arrives

They enter their name and number, tap *Send code*, and a 6-digit code lands on WhatsApp. Type all six and it verifies itself. If WhatsApp won't deliver, we quietly offer email instead.

Verifies the phone · see §4

8

Email + password → code → you're in

They set an email and password, get a 6-digit email code, and entering it **creates the account** and signs them in. Then it's off to the dashboard (or, for staff, the plan page).

Creates the customer record + sign-in · see §4–5

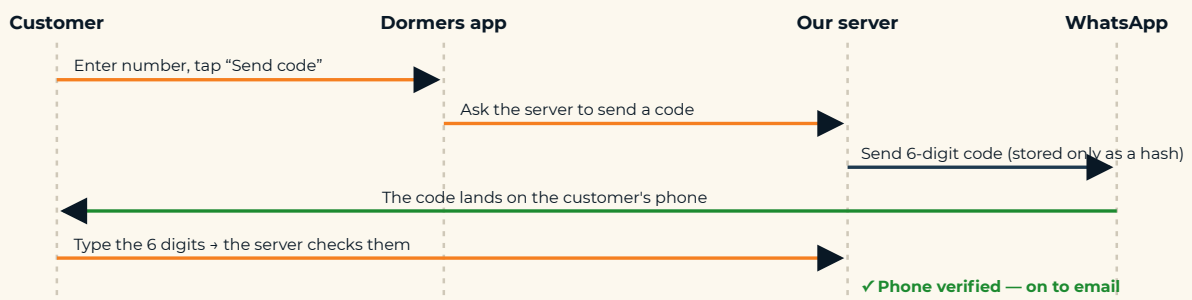
RULE · WE SAVE AS YOU GO

Everything except the password is kept in a browser draft, so a refresh or accidental back-button never loses progress. The password is deliberately left out, and a restored draft never *pretends* the phone is already verified — the real check always happens on our side.

Proving it's really you

We check identity twice — the WhatsApp number first, then the email. Both use a 6-digit code that works only once and expires fast. It's not red tape: it stops fake sign-ups and protects our delivery promise, because we only ever message a number we know is real.

THE WHATSAPP CODE, START TO FINISH



? What if WhatsApp can't deliver the code?

IT WORKED

Phone is **verified**. Straight on to the email step.

IT FAILED

We offer to **continue by email**. The account is created, but the phone is flagged *unverified* until they confirm it before their first meal.

Used once, then dead.

A code can't be reused to sign up someone else once it's been spent.

Short-lived.

Codes expire quickly, with a cooldown and an hourly limit to deter abuse.

Never delivered blind.

We never schedule a meal to an unverified number — the fallback just defers the phone check, it doesn't skip it.

The account that gets created

The moment that email code checks out, two things happen at once: they get a login, and we save a **customer profile** with everything the wizard collected. We also mint a short, dorm-based **customer ID (the "CID")** that follows them everywhere — on labels, orders, and referrals.

What we keep about a new customer

WHAT WE KEEP	WHY IT MATTERS
name, email, whatsapp_number	Who they are and how we reach them. The phone carries a "verified" flag and timestamp.
cid	Their short ID, built from their dorm — used on meal labels, orders, and referral links.
meal_preference_type	Non-Veg / Veg / Religious — drives both price and what the kitchen cooks.
week_type, veg_days	5 or 6 days a week; and, for a mix, which days are vegetarian.
allergens, spice_level_preference	Kitchen safety and taste.
dorm_name, out_of_zone	Where to deliver. An "Other" dorm sets an out-of-zone flag that pauses checkout until we confirm we cover it.

BY DESIGN · OUT OF ZONE

Picking an unlisted dorm marks the account **out of zone**. They can finish signing up, but checkout waits until ops confirms we deliver there — a deliberate guardrail, not a glitch.

SAFEGUARD · ALREADY A MEMBER?

Try to sign up with an email that already exists and you're quietly sent to the login page — we never reveal whether an email is registered.

RULE · STAFF GET LINKED AUTOMATICALLY

If this person came through the staff door, we link their new account to their staff record the instant it's created — but only if the email matches, the verified phone matches, and they finished inside the **60-minute** claim window. When it matches, they're sent to the staff plan page instead of the normal dashboard.

Choosing a plan & what it costs

From their dashboard, the customer picks a plan. There are four public plans, priced per meal. The prices below are our **built-in defaults** — but the admin panel can override any of them, and whatever ops sets there is exactly what customers see and pay.

ONE-TIME Trial 1 meal · single delivery Non-Veg AED 25 Veg AED 20	LOW COMMITMENT Weekly Flex 6 meals / week Non-Veg AED 23/meal Veg AED 19/meal	★ BEST VALUE Monthly Premium 24 meals / month Non-Veg AED 22/meal Veg AED 18/meal	FOR THE HUNGRY Monthly Max 48 meals · 2/day Non-Veg AED 21.5/meal Veg AED 17.5/meal
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Per-meal price is the same whether 5 or 6 days — a 5-day cycle simply has fewer meals, so the total is lower. Monthly Max delivers both meals together (same dish), 7–8 PM.

The "Religious Preference" mix, in one line

For a mixed week, the per-meal price is a blend of veg and non-veg days — more veg days, lower price. As a feel for it, Monthly Premium runs from about **AED 22/meal** (mostly non-veg) down to **AED 17/meal** (mostly veg), set by how many veg days they choose.

BY DESIGN • THE HIDDEN STAFF PLAN

Interns get a private **Staff Monthly** plan: the **5-day week is free** (it's their pay), and the **6-day week is a flat AED 80** — the 4 Saturdays prepaid at AED 20 each. It never shows on the public grid and only works for active staff. (Full story in §10.)

RULE • PRICES CAN'T DRIFT

The price the customer sees, the amount sent to the card, and the server's "is this amount legit?" check all read from the **same** source. Change a price in the admin panel and all three move together — there's no second price list to fall out of sync.

Checkout & payment

They pick a start date and pay. Out of sight, we roll any credits and loyalty discounts into a single coupon, double-check the price against the official rate, and — if credit covers the whole thing — skip the card payment entirely.

? Does their credit cover the whole order?

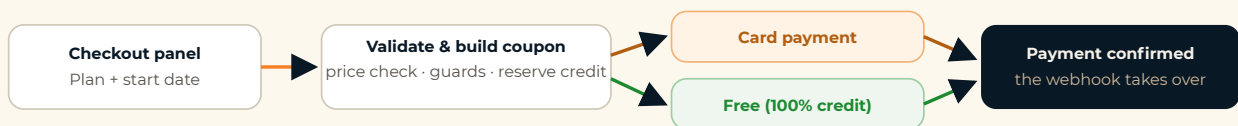
COVERS 100%

Free checkout. No card needed — we create the subscription straightaway. They still get every confirmation.

SOME LEFT TO PAY

Card payment. Off to the secure card page; the coupon brings the total down to what's owed.

FROM “PAY” TO A LIVE SUBSCRIPTION



Once paid, the system quietly does it all (and never twice):

create the subscription + order · settle credits · update preferences · reward any referrer · send the 3 confirmations (58)

RULE · THEY ONLY EVER SEE THE NET

The customer sees the price **after** credit. Behind the scenes we keep the full price and apply credit and loyalty as a coupon — credit is never quietly pre-subtracted on the way in.

HEADS-UP · THE 2 PM KITCHEN CUT-OFF

Start dates respect a **2 PM Dubai** kitchen cut-off (no same-day starts after it for new customers) and a 30-day window; non-delivery days are skipped automatically.

SAFEGUARD · CHECKOUT WILL STOP YOU FOR A REASON

Before any charge, checkout blocks if the profile's incomplete, the dorm is out of zone, a plan is paused, or a future plan is already queued (only one waiting at a time). Each one prevents a charge we couldn't cleanly honour.

Right after they pay

The second a payment clears, we want the customer to feel looked after. Three messages go out almost at once — each on its own track, so if one stumbles it never holds up the others, and none is ever sent twice.

1 WHATSAPP

"You're all set"

A WhatsApp with their plan, total, and first delivery date — within seconds.

2 EMAIL

A branded confirmation

A proper Dormers email with the order number, meals, and start date.

3 INVOICE

A tax invoice

A compliant invoice, created and emailed — held back about 2 minutes so it doesn't pile on top of the other two.

RULE · EXACTLY ONCE, NO MATTER WHAT

We drop a checkpoint after the important work, and each message has its own "sent" mark. If the card processor re-sends the same event (it happens), nothing doubles up — no second subscription, no repeat texts.

BY DESIGN · THE INVOICE WAITS ITS TURN

The tax invoice is scheduled a couple of minutes out and picked up by a regular job, rather than fired off instantly. It spaces out the customer's inbox and keeps the payment moment snappy.

Meanwhile, the customer is back on the dashboard looking at a cheerful "Checkout successful" summary. The WhatsApp and email arrive within seconds; the invoice PDF follows shortly after.

Going live: from "scheduled" to first meal

A new plan often starts as **Scheduled** — set to begin on a future date. It becomes a real, cooking-and-delivering subscription through a few small jobs that run on a clock every day, all on Dubai time.



Start day, just after midnight — it wakes up

A nightly job flips the plan from Scheduled to **Active** the moment its start date arrives. (The same job also handles skips, pauses, and finished cycles.)

status tick · 00:05 Dubai time



Start day, 9 AM — "Today's the day"

A warm welcome email goes to everyone whose plan starts today — sent once.

start-day emails · 09:00 Dubai time



Every delivery day, 8 PM — the meal counts

An evening job marks one meal delivered for each active subscriber on a delivery day, and logs the cost for the books.

delivery tick · 20:00 Dubai time



The kitchen sees them coming

The kitchen view tallies active subscribers by veg vs non-veg (respecting the mix, plus any skips or pauses) so exactly the right number of each meal gets cooked.

An estimate before the 2 PM cut-off, confirmed after

BY DESIGN · DUBAI TIME, ALL YEAR

Dubai never changes its clocks, so the schedule is rock-steady. (For the technically minded: midnight Dubai is 8 PM UTC.)

HEADS-UP · THE WELCOME EMAIL WON'T BACK-FILL

The "Today's the day" email goes out for plans starting *today* only. If a scheduled job ever skips a day, it won't go back and send late.

The staff & intern path

Interns are paid partly in meals. They onboard like everyone else, but with a claim code at the front and a private staff plan at the end — plus admin-approved renewals and a fair refund if they leave early.

1 Invite

An admin adds the intern in the admin panel, which mints a one-time claim code (good for 7 days) and sends it over WhatsApp.

2 Claim

The intern enters their email + code, which opens a **60-minute** window to finish onboarding.

3 Onboard

They go through the normal wizard. As the account is created, their staff record links up automatically — email and verified phone have to match.

4 Pick the staff plan

Two choices, below.



Which staff week do they want?

5-DAY

Free. Set up instantly, no payment — this is their pay.

6-DAY

AED 80 for the 4 prepaid Saturdays, paid by card like anyone else.

BY DESIGN · PREPAY, DON'T DEDUCT

The 6-day Saturdays are **prepaid** on purpose — taking it off a stipend at payday stings more than paying AED 80 up front. Renewals queue up and wait for an admin's approval; offboarding refunds any unused Saturdays at AED 20 each.

SAFEGUARD · CLEAN BOOKS

Staff meals are logged to their own expense category, so intern pay never gets muddled with customer-goodwill comps.

The referral path & rewards

A referred friend lands on `/r/[code]`, verifies phone + email right there, and instantly claims a free **Welcome Meal** — no wizard, no card. When that friend later becomes a paying customer, the person who invited them starts earning across four layers of rewards.

LAYER 1

Conversion cash

When the friend first pays, the inviter gets a credit that grows with their track record (~AED 20 → 35). A limited "doubler" can apply.

LAYER 2

Cycle milestones

Hitting 3 / 6 / 10 / 15 / 20 recruits in a cycle unlocks mystery cash, free weeks, and cash-plus-skips.

LAYER 3

Lifetime tiers

At 10 / 25 / 50 / 100 lifetime recruits: a standing 5% then 10% off, a big meal credit, and a jacket.

LAYER 4

Anniversary & extras

An **AED 50** credit once a customer passes a year, plus rewards for reviews and surveys.

How credits get spent: they're just AED in a wallet. At checkout they're combined with any loyalty discount into one coupon (loyalty % first, then credit fills the rest). If a credit is bigger than the order, the leftover stays in the wallet for next time.

BY DESIGN · ANNIVERSARY IS CURRENT-YEAR-ONLY

The AED 50 anniversary reward is **not** back-filled for returning dormant customers who missed past years — an owner's call, not a bug.

SAFEGUARD · FRAUD SIGNALS

Repeat device/IP patterns and lifetime phone/email checks flag suspicious claims for review; flagged credits stay pending until ops approves them.

What keeps it all safe

Onboarding touches identity and money, so it's wrapped in quiet protections. Here's the plain-English version of what keeps it honest and steady — every one of these is already in place.

THE WORRY	HOW WE HANDLE IT
Reused or replayed codes	Every verification code is single-use and short-lived; once spent, it can't sign up anyone else.
"Is this email registered?" probing	We never reveal it — existing users are quietly sent to login instead.
Someone fiddling with the price	The server re-checks the amount against the official price band; a tampered amount is rejected before any charge.
Double-charges / double-clicks	Only one scheduled plan at a time; paused plans can't check out; credits are reserved so two tabs can't spend the same balance.
The processor re-sending an event	The payment handler is idempotent — a repeated event won't create a second subscription or re-send messages.
WhatsApp going down	The email fallback keeps sign-up moving; the phone is flagged for verification before delivery.
Referral gaming	Lifetime phone/email de-dup, per-IP limits, and device/IP signals route shady claims to a review queue.
Delivering somewhere we don't cover	Unlisted dorms are blocked at checkout until ops confirms coverage.
A payment that half-finishes	A checkpoint lets the handler resume only the unfinished steps on retry, never repeating what's done.

RULE · THE PRIME DIRECTIVE

The customer in front of us comes first. Where timeouts or limits exist, they fail *gracefully* — a hiccup quietly degrades (email fallback, a deferred invoice) rather than blocking the person trying to eat.

PART 2

Technical Appendix

For engineers. The exact routes, files, tables, integrations, schedules, and the verification, pricing, and credit engines behind everything in Part 1. All paths are relative to the repo root.

[A · Route & file map](#)[B · Data model](#)[C · Integrations](#)[D · Cron schedule](#)[E · The engines](#)[F · Glossary & facts to confirm](#)

Route & file map

The path a sign-up takes through the code, in order.

FILE	ROLE
<code>src/app/components/Navbar.tsx</code>	Marketing CTAs (currently → <code>/maintenance</code>).
<code>src/app/login/LoginForm.tsx</code>	Sign-In / Sign-Up / Forgot tabs; Sign-Up routes to <code>/onboarding</code> ; forces light theme.
<code>src/app/onboarding/OnboardingClient.tsx</code>	The wizard state machine: steps, draft persistence, navigation.
<code>src/app/onboarding/Steps.tsx</code> · <code>data.ts</code>	Step renderers; preference/allergen/spice/dorm/university constants + the step type.
<code>src/app/onboarding/PhoneStep.tsx</code> · <code>EmailStep.tsx</code>	Step 6 (WhatsApp OTP) and step 7 (email OTP → account).
<code>src/app/onboarding/actions.ts</code>	<code>createAccount</code> , <code>verifyEmailOtp</code> , <code>resendEmailOtp</code> — validate, upsert customer, consume OTP, link staff.
<code>src/app/api/whatsapp/start</code> · <code>check/route.ts</code>	Send + verify the WhatsApp 6-digit code.
<code>src/app/staff/claim/*</code> · <code>r/[cid]/*</code>	Door 2 (staff claim) and Door 3 (referral gift, incl. <code>claimGift</code>).
<code>src/app/dashboard/plan/*</code> · <code>_mobile/MobileExplore.tsx</code>	Plan grid + <code>CheckoutPanel</code> (desktop) / bottom sheet (mobile).
<code>src/app/api/checkout/route.ts</code>	Validate price/guards, synthesize coupon, reserve credit, Stripe or free-checkout.
<code>src/app/api/webhook/route.ts</code>	Verifies Stripe signature → <code>handle-stripe-event.ts</code> .
<code>contexts/payments/usecases/handle-stripe-event.ts</code>	Creates subscription + order, settles credits, links referral, fans out.
<code>contexts/payments/usecases/post-payment-fanout.ts</code> · <code>free-checkout.ts</code>	3-channel confirmations; the 100%-credit provisioning path.

Data model

The tables onboarding writes or reads, with the columns that matter most.

TABLE	KEY COLUMNS / PURPOSE
customers	id, cid, email, name, whatsapp_number, whatsapp_verified(+_at), meal_preference_type, week_type, veg_days, allergens, spice_level_preference, dorm_name, out_of_zone + pending_* staging.
subscriptions	customer_id, plan_name, status (Scheduled/Active/Paused/Skipped/Ended), start_date, end_date, week_type, meals_per_day, total_meals, delivered_meals, veg_days, bonus_meals, staff_approval.
orders	stripe_session_id, order_number, plan, meals_count, price_per_meal, invoice_status, webhook_completed_at, whatsapp_sent_at, email_sent_at, zoho_invoice_id.
whatsapp_otps	phone, code_hash (HMAC), expires_at, verified_at, consumed_at, send_failed_at. Single-use, hashed.
plan_pricing	Admin price overrides: plan_id, preference, week_type, veg_day_count, price_per_meal, effective_from, effective_to (exclusive).
credits	customer_id, amount_aed, source, status (pending/approved/reserved/applied/rejected), referral_id, applied_to.
referrals · referral_gifts_claimed · referral_review_queue	Attribution (inviter_cid, invitee_user_id, status), lifetime de-dup (phone_e164, email_norm), and fraud-review rows.
cycle_rewards · lifetime_rewards · layer4_rewards	The four reward layers, each with uniqueness keys so they fire once.
staff_members	email, whatsapp_number, claim_code_hash, code_expires_at, code_verified_at, status (invited/active/ended), customer_id.
customer_notifications	Outbound WhatsApp queue: kind, payload, scheduled_for, sent_at, wamid.
comped_meal_ledger · dorm_locations	Per-meal cost ledger (incl. staff_comped_meals); the live dorm list + zone.

Integrations

SYSTEM	ROLE IN ONBOARDING
Stripe	Checkout sessions; coupons for credit/loyalty; webhook on success; refunds (staff offboarding). API version pinned, 8s timeout, retries.
Meta WhatsApp Cloud API	OTP template (locale <code>en</code>); order/welcome notifications (locales <code>en_US</code> / <code>en_AE</code> per template). Sent via the DB dispatcher using <code>pg_net</code> .
ZeptoMail	Branded transactional emails (order confirmation, start-day, refund). Circuit-breaker protected.
Zoho Books	Tax-compliant invoice created + emailed, deferred ~2 min and dispatched by an hourly job.
Supabase	Auth (email/password + email OTP), Postgres + RLS, vault secrets, <code>pg_net</code> , <code>pg_cron</code> .

Cron schedule (Asia/Dubai)

JOB	WHEN	DOES
subscription_status_tick	00:05 AE (20:05 UTC)	Scheduled→Active, skip/pause transitions, end completed cycles.
subscription_pause_tick	00:10 AE (20:10 UTC)	Increments paused days; pushes end date out.
subscription_delivery_tick	20:00 AE (16:00 UTC)	Records a delivered meal per active sub on a delivery day; logs cost.
dispatch_start_day_emails	09:00 AE (05:00 UTC)	Sends the "Today's the day" email for plans starting today.
dispatch_customer_notifications	every 5 min	Drains the WhatsApp queue (verified numbers only).
Zoho-due dispatch	hourly	Creates + emails the deferred tax invoice.
post-payment retry · credit cleanup	periodic	Retries failed fan-out channels; releases stale credit reservations.

Delivery days: 6DAYS = Mon–Sat (not Sun); 5DAYS = Mon–Fri; 7DAYS = every day.

Verification, pricing & credit engines

Verification

- WhatsApp codes are **HMAC-SHA256** hashed (`src/shared/otp-hash.ts`), bound to the phone; never stored in plaintext.
- Single-use** via `consumed_at`; short TTL; resend cooldown + hourly send cap; the verify-attempt counter is atomic against brute force.
- Email OTP is Supabase Auth (6-digit). The email fallback is honoured only when a real `send_failed_at` exists; the account is marked `whatsapp_verified=false`.

Pricing

- Pure engine `contexts/subscriptions/domain/pricing.ts` (defaults) + DB overrides via `infra/supabase/pricing-repo.ts` (`plan_pricing`).
- Override priority (Religious): `(week, count) → (6DAYS, count) → (week, flat) → (6DAYS, flat)`; Veg/NonVeg: `(week) → (6DAYS)`.
- Per-meal is week-type-invariant for Veg/NonVeg; the Religious mix is a weighted average of veg/non-veg days.
- `priceBoundsFils()` derives the checkout floor/ceiling from the same engine — the server's tamper check moves in lockstep with admin price changes.

Credits & coupons

- `contexts/dorm-wars/domain/coupon-synth.ts` builds **one** Stripe coupon: loyalty % first, then credit caps the remainder.
- Credits are **reserved** (24h) before checkout so two tabs can't double-spend; FIFO consumption with a split-remainder row for leftovers.
- The webhook is idempotent via `orders.webhook_completed_at` + per-channel sent markers; a full refund returns credits to the wallet.

Glossary & facts to confirm

Glossary

TERM	MEANING
CID	Customer ID — a short, dorm-based identifier used across labels, orders, and referrals.
week_type	5DAYS (Mon–Fri) or 6DAYS (Mon–Sat). Drives meal count and delivery days.
veg_days	For "Religious Preference": which weekdays are vegetarian.
fils	1/100 of an AED. Card amounts are handled in fils (AED × 100).
AE time	Asia/Dubai, UTC+4 year-round (no daylight saving).
tick	A scheduled job (cron) that advances state on a clock instead of on a user action.
fan-out	Sending several independent confirmations (WhatsApp/email/invoice) after one event.
out_of_zone	An account in an unlisted dorm; checkout blocked until coverage is confirmed.

Facts to confirm with the owner before publishing

- Public funnel gate:** the marketing navbar currently points *Log In / Get Started* at `/maintenance`. Confirm whether the public sign-up door is intentionally closed or should point to `/login`.
- WhatsApp templates:** confirm the live template names + locales are approved in Meta Business Manager (`en` / `en_US` / `en_AE`).
- OTP secret:** confirm `OTP_PEPPER` is set in production (otherwise it falls back to the service-role key).
- Reward figures:** exact Layer 1–4 amounts evolve; treat the numbers here as indicative and check current config before quoting externally.

MAINTAINING THIS DOCUMENT

Source HTML: `docs/onboarding/onboarding-flow.html`. Regenerate the PDF with `node scripts/render-onboarding-pdf.mjs`. Brand values come from `src/app/globals.css` and `src/ui-system/tokens/*`.